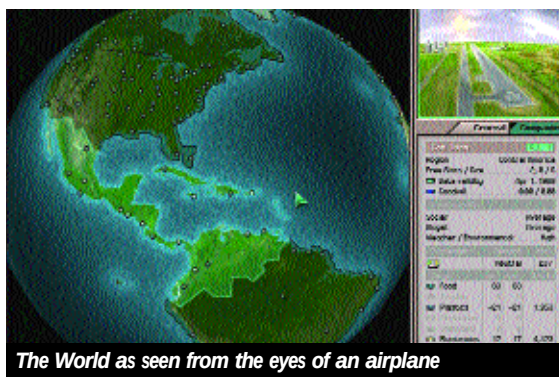


AIRLINES2

Clipped Wings

The interface of *Airlines2* is very simple, with three main screens sub-divided into several tabbed windows. The airports are grouped under fifteen zones classified by geographical location. Players start out by selecting one region, and then establishing routes and connecting airports together. There are several conditions such as passenger demand, type of service required, etc., that need to be met to set up a profitable route. All this information can be obtained by researching airports, but this research only remains accurate for a set amount of time, thereby adding a good degree of realism to the gameplay. Another nice feature is the inclusion of real-world aircraft in the game, despite their corrupted names, such as the Concoard and the Boodwing 747.



The World as seen from the eyes of an airplane

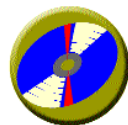
As the game rolls on from its start date of 1960, planes are refreshed accordingly.

As the game progresses, the increasing strain of micro-managing fifty-odd routes really gets tiresome. Another disconcerting fact is the number of crashes your planes sustain mid-game, and the high

cost of replacing them. The game does list the total flying time of the aircraft, but it would have been more useful to include a projected estimate of its useful life. The game's Finance screen too appears a little simplistic—if you need a loan, your bank will allow you to set the interest rates. Also, the competition's progress is reported only once every year. So in the end, you find yourself just sitting and waiting for any event to happen... and waiting, and waiting...

The in-game music though is a different matter, with its horrendous techno sounds in tow. Beyond the simple animations of airports and planes that play in the right-hand corner, the game only looks like a jazzed-up version of an Excel sheet. Business-sim enthusiasts would be better off buying *Airport Tycoon 3*.

Genre: Strategy ■ **Developer:** InterActive Vision ■ **Publisher:** Take2 Interactive ■ **Distributor:** Sujata Softech ■ **Phone:** (022) 22885096 / 46574
System requirements: 500 MHz CPU, 64 MB RAM, 32 MB 3D accelerator card, 350 MB hard disk space, DirectX 8.0a
Price: Rs 299 ■ **Web site:** <http://pc.iavgames.com/airlines2/>
Rating: ★★★★★



Vietnam Med Evac

Land, Puhleez!

Based on the Vietnam War, *Vietnam Med Evac* gives you command and control of the UH1 Huey helicopter to go out into the wild, rescue dying souls and relieve their pain. Use the joystick for better control over the Huey. For hardcore FPS players, controlling the Huey will take some time. Taking off is child's play, but keeping the Huey stable in the air and landing is what makes this game real fun (or frustrating!). Landing is the game's most critical aspect.

The game's a tough nut to crack, the reason being the patience and willpower required to control the flight paths and situations with controls provided. This is what makes up for the average graphics and stupid AI (civilians keep approaching you even when bul-



Nocturnal missions can be a nightmare. Defeat the darkness with a flare or two

lets are fired at them).

The sound effects bring to life the real action around you. The instant feedback you get due to over-pitching or rolling makes you sit at the edge of your seat.

The Huey's gun is hardly accurate—it seems like something that's meant for random destruction. Another grouse is its manual that actually belongs to another game in the Search And Rescue series—*Coastal Heroes*. An AI pilot was also sorely missed, as you need one to fly the chopper if you decide to man the gun if hostilities arise.

Graphics are poor. Mountains, plateaus and even water seem developed for a TNT-based system. All said and done, this game is good value for money, as it'll take at least a month to complete all the missions. It's loaded with around 100 missions, which is enough to make the gamer clock enough flying time to try the real Huey if the chance ever comes by.

Genre: Simulation ■ **Developer:** InterActive Vision ■ **Publisher:** Global Star Software ■ **Distributor:** Sujata Softech
Phone: (022) 22885096 / 46574 ■ **System requirements:** (800 MHz CPU, 64 MB RAM, 1 GB hard disk space, DirectX 8.1, 32 MB 3D accelerator)
Price: Rs 299 ■ **Web site:** <http://pc.iavgames.com/vme>
Rating: ★★★★★